

one essential quality of sound is that it bounces off surfaces. Every heard an echo? That's sound bouncing off other surfaces and coming back to you.

Every area lends its own characteristics to sound. The same area also has sound of its own. This is called room tone and you NEED it while making a movie and want to get rid of while recording music.

This is why all sound studios are covered in carpets, have bumpy surfaces everywhere, especially inside the recording room. The carpets dampen the sound by not letting them bounce around. The uneven surfaces make sure the sound doesn't bounce off opposite walls give you echos. Sound stu-



Ooh! Bumpy!

dios also have two doors at every doorway. One for the room you're leaving and one for the room you're entering. Some super high profile studios actually float on springs to cancel out vibrations from the ground.

So in essence, the room where you're recording your audio must be sound proofed and the sound must be dead as Robin Williams (too soon?).

Before we move on to the next section, lets do a short note on what you need to do when you do dub in studio.

If you're in a recording booth and you're recording the dialogues for a movie, you either didn't get our hints on how dubbing is bad or you're voicing an animated flick or are a voice over artist. In which case, can you do Aladdin from the movie Aladdin?

Jokes aside, if you're a VO artist, you'll be observing the same practices you would observe while recording music. The same goes for delivering dialogues. But, another important aspect of recording sound especially while dubbing is the room tone. As mentioned above, the room tone is what makes the listener believe that the characters are actually at that location. If you were to put a flat voice for a scene where the characters in a cave, people will be leaving so fast, their shadows won't be able to keep up. So remember to shoot 10 to 20 seconds of silence at every location to record the ambient